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POLICY & PROCEDURE

Delegation of Authority Policy

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1. Purpose

To provide guidelines for the appropriate delegation of signature authority for payment authorizations and procurements for project funded financial transactions. This policy also addresses signature authority and approval authority with respect to executing cover sheets, and contracts or grants.

Indirect expenses can be approved by admin VPs for expenses that have been budgeted in the current year original budget or the forecast.

2. Effective Date

This policy/procedure is effective on November 01, 2023

3. Thresholds for Signatory Approvers

The following positions are authorized to sign payment requests, procurements, cover sheets, contracts, and grants up to the indicated thresholds below in USD.

Home Office Position	Threshold
Vice Presidents (VPs), Chief Operating Officer (COO), Chief Financial Officer (CFO)	$1,000,000
Senior Directors I and II, POA Mexico and Colombia Country Directors	$500,000
Directors I and II	$250,000
Associate Directors	$50,000

Field Office Position*	Threshold
Project Director/Chief of Party (PD/COP)	$10,000 - $100,000**
Deputy Project Director/Deputy Chief of Party (DPD/DCOP)	$5,000 - $50,000**

Approval requests should always be routed to the lowest level of signatory authority appropriate for the amount. Reference Annex A: Approval Matrix Cheat Sheet.

*Please note that for the Colombia and Mexico offices, only the POA Country Office Director has approval authority for contracts.

****Approval defaults to $10,000 for PD/COPs and $5,000 for DPD/DCOPs.** On case-by-case basis with approval from the Senior Vice President of Programs, and the Country Director or Home Office Senior Director the limit can be increased up to a max of $100,000 for PD/COPs an $50,000 for DPD/DCOPs. The limit provided to each field office position will be determined based on performance and compliance with POA policies.

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3.1 Payment Authorizations

Permission is given and delegated by the President & CEO to approve payments, release payments from the bank and sign checks for payment. This approval attests to the appropriateness and allowability of the transaction within the POA and relates to project funded transactions.

3.2 Cover Sheet and Contract/Grant Authorizations

Prior to engaging in a contract or agreement on behalf of POA a cover sheet MUST be signed by the VP/HO Directors/COP/PD based on the appropriate approvers per the delegation above, the Contracts Team, and the Compliance Team. The President & CEO will sign cover sheets AND contracts larger than the VP's, COO's, CFO's delegation authority. Once the cover sheet has been signed by the VP/HO Director/COP/PD, it will be sent to the Contracts Team at contracts@partners.net for review, tracking, and potential FFATA reporting requirements. Once the Contracts Team has approved, the cover sheet, will be sent to the Compliance Team for review of procurement documentation and contract details at compliance@partners.net. If necessary, the final cover sheet step will be signature by the President & CEO. All staff should be completing the contract and cover sheet directly in PandaDoc.

When the coversheet is signed by the funding source approver, their signature only attests for the budget approval and appropriateness of the cost to the award. The individual signing the agreement is responsible for that contract or grant, not the cover sheet approver.

3.3 Procurement Authorizations

For procurements purchase requisition forms require technical authorization from programmatic team based on the delegation of authority listed above. On the purchase requisition form the HO Director/COP/PD is responsible for reviewing the request and ensuring that the good or service is necessary for the project and that the expected award value is appropriate. The unit Vice President/COO/CFO/Country Office Director and/or President & CEO provides authorizations for large purchases above the HO Director/COP/PD's approval threshold. The Compliance Team will be copied on the PRF and spot check to flag any potential issues (i.e. restricted commodities which may need prior approval and or waivers, wrong procurement method selected, wrong source selection selected, etc.).

For evaluation matrixes, negotiation memos, and source selection memos they are to be signed by the appropriate HO Director/COP/PD based on the dollar value of the procurement. If the procurement exceeds the HO Director/COP/PD authority, it will instead require approval from the Vice President/COO/CFO/Country Office Director and/or President & CEO as appropriate. Please note all sole source memos require approval from Compliance Team as well. By signing the evaluation matrixes, negotiation memos, and source selection memos the approver is certifying that they have reviewed the procurement package and it is correctly documented, and that they agree with the final selected vendor.

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4. Payment Approval

4.1 Home Office Payment Approval

When payments are submitted in Bill.com, the platform will route the approvals based on the authorization of the individual submitting. The thresholds noted above will be the roles in Bill.com for payment approvals on behalf of the President & CEO as relates to the programmatic expenses. Respective Unit VPs will sign all administrative costs.

4.2 Field Office Payment Approval

All field office payment requests must be submitted in PandaDoc on the Payment Request Form. The programmatic approval will be provided by the appropriate approver based on the delegation above. The individual signing the payment request form as a technical approver is confirming the allowability and appropriateness of the cost for the program and the correct budget activity. The F&A Director approver signature is verifying and matching up the vendor invoice, supporting documentation, the procurement file, and the signed payment request.

5. Release of Payment Internal Controls

The below internal controls apply to all payments released from our bank accounts, PayPal, Airtm, or any other payment platform.

5.1 Home Office Release of Payment Internal Controls

Only the President & CEO and the CFO have the ability to release payments in Bill.com or the bank account.

5.2 Field Office Release of Payment Internal Controls

Only the Country Director (if applicable) and the Finance Director have the ability to release payments from local bank accounts.

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Annex A: Approval Matrix Cheat Sheet

Purchase Requisitions Form (PRF) Approval Authority

All PRF for technical approval should follow the below approval process as applicable based on positions with program/unit. If your program/unit does not have a particular position, move to the next highest approval authority.

- PRF between $0 - $5,000 USD – Deputy Project Director/Deputy Chief of Party*
- PRF between $5,001 - $10,000 USD – Project Director/Chief of Party*
- PRF between $10,001 - $50,000 USD – Associate Director at Home Office
- PRF between $50,001 - $250,000 USD –Director at Home Office
- PRF between $250,001 - $500,000 USD –Senior Director at Home Office
- PRF between $500,001 - $1,000,000 USD – VPs, COO, and CFO
- PFR more than $1,000,000 USD – President & CEO

* Unless higher delegation amount is approved by Senior VP of Program and the Country Director or Home Office Senior Director.

Source Selection Memo, Negotiation Memos, and Evaluation Matrixes Approval Authority

All source selection memos, negotiation memos, and evaluation matrixes approval should follow the below approval process as applicable based on positions with program/unit. If your program/unit does not have a particular position, move to the next highest approval authority. Note that sole source memos require Compliance Team approvals.

For home office and field offices without POA Country Office Director:

- Memos and Matrixes between $0 - $5,000 USD – Deputy Project Director/Deputy Chief of Party*
- Memos and Matrixes between $5,001 - $10,000 USD - Project Director/Chief of Party*
- Memos and Matrixes between $10,001 - $50,000 USD – Associate Director at Home Office
- Memos and Matrixes between $50,001 - $250,000 USD –Director at Home Office
- Memos and Matrixes between $250,001 - $500,000 USD –Senior Director at Home Office
- Memos and Matrixes between $500,001 - $1,000,000 USD – VPs, COO, and CFO
- Memos and Matrixes more than $1,000,000 USD – President & CEO

For Mexico and Colombia with POA Country Office Director:

- Memos and Matrixes between $0 - $5,000 USD – Deputy Project Director/Deputy Chief of Party*
- Memos and Matrixes between $5,001 - $10,000 USD - Project Director/Chief of Party*

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- Memos and Matrixes between $10,001 - $500,000 USD – Mexico and Colombia Country Directors
- Memos and Matrixes between $500,001 - $1,000,000 USD – VPs, COO, and CFO
- Memos and Matrixes more than $1,000,000 USD – President & CEO

* Unless higher delegation amount is approved by Senior VP of Program and the Country Director or Home Office Senior Director.

Payment Request Approval Authority

All payment request approvals should follow the below approval process as applicable based on positions with program/unit. If your program/unit does not have a particular position, move to the next highest approval authority.

For home office and field offices without POA Country Office Director:

- Payments between $0 - $5,000 USD – Deputy Project Director/Deputy Chief of Party*
- Payments between $5,001 - $10,000 USD - Project Director/Chief of Party*
- Payments between $10,001 - $50,000 USD – Associate Director at Home Office
- Payments between $50,001 - $250,000 USD –Director at Home Office
- Payments between $250,001 - $500,000 USD –Senior Director at Home Office
- Payments between $500,001 - $1,000,000 USD – VPs, COO, and CFO
- Payments more than $1,000,000 USD – President & CEO

For Mexico and Colombia with POA Country Office Director:

- Payments between $0 - $5,000 USD – Deputy Project Director/Deputy Chief of Party*
- Payments between $5,001 - $10,000 USD - Project Director/Chief of Party*
- Payments between $10,001 - $500,000 USD – Mexico and Colombia Country Directors
- Payments between $500,001 - $1,000,000 USD – VPs, COO, and CFO
- Payments more than $1,000,000 USD – President & CEO

* Unless higher delegation amount is approved by Senior VP of Program and the Country Director or Home Office Senior Director.

Contract Cover Sheet (CS) Approval Authority

All contract cover sheet approvals should follow the below approval process as applicable based on positions with program/unit. If your program/unit does not have a particular position, move to the next highest approval authority.

For home office and field offices without POA Country Office Director:

- CS between $0 - $5,000 USD – Deputy Project Director/Deputy Chief of Party*

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- CS between $5,001 - $10,000 USD - Project Director/Chief of Party*
- CS between $10,001 - $50,000 USD – Associate Director at Home Office
- CS between $50,001 - $250,000 USD –Director at Home Office
- CS between $250,001 - $500,000 USD –Senior Director at Home Office
- CS between $500,001 - $1,000,000 USD – VPs, COO, and CFO
- CS more than $1,000,000 USD – President & CEO

For Mexico and Colombia with POA Country Office Director:

- CS between $0 - $5,000 USD – Deputy Project Director/Deputy Chief of Party*
- CS between $5,001 - $10,000 USD – Project Director/Chief of Party*
- CS between $10,001 - $500,000 USD – Mexico and Colombia Country Directors
- CS between $500,001 - $1,000,000 USD – VPs, COO, and CFO
- CS more than $1,000,000 USD – President & CEO

* Unless higher delegation amount is approved by Senior VP of Program and the Country Director or Home Office Senior Director.

Contract AND Grant Approval Authority

All contracts and grant approvals should follow the below approval process as applicable based on positions with program/unit. If your program/unit does not have a particular position, move to the next highest approval authority. Please note that for the Colombia and Mexico offices, only the POA Country Office Director has approval authority.

For home office and field offices without POA Country Office Director:

- Contract between $0 - $5,000 USD – Deputy Project Director/Deputy Chief of Party*
- Contract between $5,001 - $10,000 USD – Project Director/Chief of Party*
- Contract between $10,001 - $50,000 USD – Associate Director at Home Office
- Contract between $50,001 - $250,000 USD –Director at Home Office
- Contract between $250,001 - $500,000 USD –Senior Director at Home Office
- Contract between $500,001 - $1,000,000 USD – VPs, COO, and CFO
- Contract more than $1,000,000 USD – President & CEO

For Mexico and Colombia with POA Country Office Director:

- Contract between $0 - $500,000 USD – Mexico and Colombia Country Directors
- Contract between $500,001 - $1,000,000 USD – VPs, COO, and CFO
- Contract more than $1,000,000 USD – President & CEO

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* Unless higher delegation amount is approved by Senior VP of Program and the Country Director or Home Office Senior Director.

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